LESSON 6

Biblical Foods, Herbs, Oils & Spices

Nourishment • Provision • Stewardship • Safe Study

Course: NHMEC Biblical Herbalism Foundations
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Lesson: Lesson 6
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Lesson Overview

In Lesson 1, we learned that Biblical Herbalism begins with God as Creator. In Lesson 2, we learned what it means to be a Christian herbalist. In Lesson 3, we studied discernment and spiritual boundaries. In Lesson 4, we studied the Good Samaritan model of compassionate care. In Lesson 5, we studied prayer, scripture, and whole-person wellness.

In this lesson, we will begin looking more closely at **biblical foods, herbs, oils, and spices**.

The Bible contains many references to plants, foods, trees, oils, seeds, spices, fruits, grains, resins, and herbs. These were part of daily life in biblical times. They were used for food, nourishment, fragrance, trade, gifts, anointing, lamps, skin care, burial customs, cleansing, and practical household use.

As Christian herbal students, we must learn to study biblical plants with reverence, accuracy, safety, and wisdom.

We do not exaggerate what the Bible says.
We do not turn every biblical plant into a medical claim.
We do not use scripture to create unsafe formulas.
We do not ignore allergies, medications, pregnancy, children, or medical conditions.
We do not worship the plant.
We honor God for His provision.

Biblical foods and herbs can teach us about nourishment, stewardship, provision, simplicity, preparation, and gratitude.

Lesson Scripture Foundations

Genesis 1:29 KJV

“And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat.”

Psalm 104:14 KJV

“He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and herb for the service of man: that he may bring forth food out of the earth.”

Ezekiel 47:12 KJV

“And by the river upon the bank thereof, on this side and on that side, shall grow all trees for meat, whose leaf shall not fade, neither shall the fruit thereof be consumed: it shall bring forth new fruit according to his months, because their waters they issued out of the sanctuary: and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine.”

Deuteronomy 8:8 KJV

“A land of wheat, and barley, and vines, and fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of oil olive, and honey.”

Song of Solomon 4:14 KJV

“Spikenard and saffron; calamus and cinnamon, with all trees of frankincense; myrrh and aloes, with all the chief spices.”

Matthew 2:11 KJV

“And when they were come into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his mother, and fell down, and worshipped him:
and when they had opened their treasures, they presented unto him gifts; gold, and frankincense, and myrrh.”

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. Identify several foods, herbs, oils, and spices mentioned in Scripture.
2. Explain why biblical plants should be studied in context.
3. Understand the difference between biblical mention, traditional use, and modern wellness education.
4. Recognize food as part of body stewardship.
5. Discuss olive oil, honey, grains, fruits, legumes, nuts, and spices from a biblical wellness perspective.

6. Explain why safety, allergies, and proper preparation matter.
7. Practice creating a short biblical food or herb study.

Opening Teaching

Food is one of the first ways God provided for mankind.

Before man built cities, schools, stores, clinics, or kitchens, God placed food in the garden. Genesis 1:29 shows us herbs bearing seed and trees yielding fruit. From the beginning, nourishment was connected to God's provision.

This matters because Biblical Herbalism should not begin with complicated formulas. It should begin with gratitude for simple provision.

Food matters.
Seeds matter.
Fruits matter.
Herbs matter.
Oils matter.
Spices matter.
Preparation matters.
Stewardship matters.

In modern wellness spaces, people often chase rare supplements, expensive protocols, and complicated programs while neglecting the simple foundations of nourishment. Biblical Herbalism calls us back to wisdom.

What has God already provided?
What foods nourish the body?
What simple herbs can be used safely?
What does scripture teach us about stewardship?
What can we learn from biblical foods without making false claims?

A Christian herbal student must learn to see food and herbs as part of God's provision, not as objects of fear or worship.

Biblical Plants Must Be Studied in Context

When a plant is mentioned in Scripture, we must ask careful questions.

Where is the plant mentioned?
Who is using it?
What is happening in the passage?
Is it being used as food?

Is it being used as fragrance?
Is it being used in worship?
Is it being used for trade?
Is it being used for burial?
Is it being used symbolically?
Is it being used practically?
Is the Bible giving a command, a description, or a historical detail?

This is important because not every biblical mention is a wellness instruction.

For example, frankincense and myrrh were given as gifts to Jesus. That does not mean every student should use frankincense and myrrh internally. Cinnamon is mentioned among precious spices, but that does not mean it is safe for everyone in concentrated forms. Olive oil appears in food, lamps, anointing, and care, but that does not make olive oil a cure-all.

A Christian herbal student must learn to separate:

Biblical mention
Historical context
Traditional use
Modern research
Personal use
Safety concerns
Educational language

This is how we study with wisdom.

Biblical Foods as Nourishment

Many biblical foods were simple, whole, and connected to daily life.

People ate fruits, grains, legumes, vegetables, fish, milk products, nuts, seeds, herbs, and oils. Food was tied to family, hospitality, celebration, worship, provision, and survival.

In Biblical Herbalism, we study food as a foundation of body stewardship.

Before asking, “What herb should I take?” it is wise to ask:

Am I eating nourishing food?
Am I drinking enough water?
Am I resting?
Am I caring for digestion?
Am I eating too much processed food?
Am I honoring the body with daily choices?
Am I using food with gratitude or fear?

Herbs are helpful, but they are not a replacement for nourishment.

A weak body may need food before formulas.
A tired body may need rest before stimulants.
A stressed soul may need peace before protocols.
A confused student may need simplicity before advanced study.

Biblical foods remind us that wellness often begins with simple stewardship.

Fruits in the Bible

The Bible mentions fruits such as figs, grapes, and pomegranates.

These fruits were used as food, drink, cakes, symbols, gifts, and signs of abundance. They remind us that God's provision can be both nourishing and beautiful.

Figs

Figs are mentioned many times in Scripture. They were eaten fresh or dried and were part of the food culture of Bible lands.

Figs can remind the Christian student of nourishment, sweetness, and provision. They also remind us that plants may have both literal and symbolic meaning in Scripture.

When studying figs, ask:

Where are figs mentioned?
Are they being eaten?
Are they symbolic?
Are they part of a story or prophecy?
What is the difference between a biblical fig reference and a modern wellness claim?

Grapes

Grapes were important in biblical life. They were eaten fresh, dried as raisins, pressed into juice or wine, and connected with vineyards, harvest, and abundance.

Grapes can remind students of fruitfulness, cultivation, and stewardship.

A vineyard required planting, pruning, waiting, guarding, harvesting, and tending. This can teach us that wellness also requires tending.

Pomegranates

Pomegranates appear in Scripture as a fruit and as a decorative symbol. They are associated with beauty, abundance, and richness.

Pomegranates remind us that God's creation contains color, design, nourishment, and meaning.

When teaching about pomegranates, use careful language. A student may discuss general nourishment, antioxidants, and traditional food use, but should avoid claiming that pomegranates cure disease.

Honey

Honey is one of the most beloved foods mentioned in Scripture.

The promised land was described as a land flowing with milk and honey. Honey was valued as food, sweetness, gift, and metaphor. Psalm 119:103 compares the sweetness of God's words to honey.

Honey teaches us several lessons:

God's provision can be sweet.
Nourishment can be simple.
Food can carry spiritual symbolism.
Sweetness in Scripture can point to delight in God's Word.

Honey may be used as a natural sweetener, but students must remember safety.

Honey should not be given to infants under one year old.
People with blood sugar concerns must use wisdom.
Honey allergies or sensitivities may occur.
Honey should not be presented as a cure.

Safe language:

"Honey is a biblical food traditionally valued for sweetness and nourishment. It may be used as part of general food stewardship, but it is not a replacement for medical care."

Olive Oil

Olive oil is one of the most important oils in Scripture.

Olive oil was used for food, bread, lamps, skin care, anointing, and practical care. It appears throughout the Bible in both daily and sacred contexts.

Olive oil teaches us about:

Provision
Preparation
Light
Anointing
Hospitality
Practical care
Stewardship
Consecration

The Good Samaritan story also mentions oil. In that setting, oil was part of the Samaritan's practical care for the wounded man.

However, students must avoid unsafe claims.

Do not say:

"Olive oil heals all wounds."
"Olive oil replaces medical treatment."
"Anointing oil guarantees healing."
"This oil has power by itself."

Instead, say:

"Olive oil was an important biblical oil used in food, lamps, anointing, and practical care. In Christian herbal education, it may be studied as part of biblical plant and oil history. God is the healer, and oil should not be treated as magical or as a replacement for medical care."

Olive oil also gives students a safe entry point into herbal preparations. Many herbal oils use olive oil as a carrier oil for topical preparations. Students must still learn sanitation, labeling, allergy awareness, shelf life, and appropriate use.

Fish

Fish was an important food in biblical times. Several disciples were fishermen, and Jesus fed multitudes with fish and bread.

Fish can teach us about provision, multiplication, nourishment, and the ordinary foods of daily life.

However, students must be careful with allergies and dietary restrictions.

Fish is not appropriate for everyone.
People with fish or seafood allergies must avoid it.

Some people avoid fish for religious, personal, ethical, or medical reasons.
Fish quality, sourcing, and contamination concerns may matter.

In this course, fish should be studied as a biblical food, but not forced as a required wellness food.

Safe language:

“Fish was a common and meaningful biblical food. For those who safely consume it, it may be part of nourishment. Those with allergies, sensitivities, or dietary restrictions should avoid it and seek other appropriate protein sources.”

Vegetables and Garlic

Vegetables are part of simple nourishment. Garlic is often discussed as a biblical food connected to the Israelites’ memory of Egypt.

Garlic has a long history of culinary and traditional use. It is strong, flavorful, and widely used in cooking.

Garlic may be studied as:

A food
A kitchen herb
A seasoning
A traditional wellness herb
A plant with strong actions that requires safety awareness

Students must remember that garlic is not appropriate for everyone in medicinal amounts.

Garlic may bother digestion.
Garlic may interact with blood-thinning medications.
Garlic may not be appropriate before surgery.
Garlic may cause odor, reflux, irritation, or allergy in some people.
Garlic should not be used to replace antibiotics or medical care.

Safe language:

“Garlic is a biblical and traditional food herb. It may be used in cooking and studied for its traditional wellness uses, but concentrated garlic should be used with caution, especially with medications, surgery, bleeding concerns, or sensitive digestion.”

Sprouted Grains and Bread

Bread appears throughout Scripture and is often connected to provision, hospitality, covenant, daily life, and spiritual meaning.

Jesus referred to Himself as the Bread of Life. This shows us that bread can carry both physical and spiritual meaning.

Biblical breads were not like many modern refined breads. Ancient breads were often made from whole grains, and grain preparation could include grinding, soaking, fermenting, or other traditional methods.

Sprouted grains and fermented breads may remind students of:

Preparation
Patience
Digestibility
Daily provision
Simple nourishment
The spiritual lesson of Christ as the Bread of Life

However, students must be careful with food sensitivities.

Some people cannot tolerate gluten.
Some have celiac disease and must avoid wheat, barley, and rye.
Some people need blood sugar support and must be mindful of portions.
Some people tolerate sourdough better, but that does not make it safe for everyone.

Safe language:

“Bread and grains were central in biblical life. Whole, properly prepared grains may be nourishing for many people, but those with gluten intolerance, celiac disease, allergies, or blood sugar concerns need individualized guidance from qualified professionals.”

Goat Milk and Milk Products

Milk and honey are part of biblical imagery connected to abundance and provision. Goat milk and goat products were common in ancient settings.

Goat milk may be studied as:

A traditional food
A source of nourishment
A part of ancient daily life
A symbol connected to provision

Students must remember that milk is not safe or appropriate for everyone.

Some people are dairy-free.
Some have lactose intolerance.
Some have dairy allergy.
Some avoid dairy for personal or medical reasons.
Raw milk can carry safety risks and is regulated differently by location.

A Christian herbalist should not pressure students or clients to use milk products.

Safe language:

“Goat milk was part of biblical food culture and may be studied as a traditional food. Individuals with dairy allergy, lactose intolerance, immune concerns, pregnancy, or safety concerns should seek appropriate guidance and avoid unsafe products.”

Beans and Lentils

Beans and lentils were widely used foods in biblical times. Lentils appear in the Old Testament, including in the account of Esau selling his birthright for pottage.

Legumes are nourishing, simple, and affordable foods.

They can teach us about:

Humility
Daily provision
Protein
Fiber
Stewardship
Simple meals
Family nourishment

Beans and lentils can be part of a practical kitchen wellness foundation. They are often affordable and accessible.

However, some people have digestive difficulty with legumes. Proper soaking, rinsing, cooking, spices, and gradual introduction may improve tolerance for some people.

Safe language:

“Beans and lentils are simple biblical foods that may support nourishment for many people. They should be prepared properly and adjusted according to individual tolerance.”

Nuts and Almonds

Almonds are mentioned in Scripture and are connected with nourishment, beauty, and symbolism. Aaron's rod that budded brought forth almonds, making the almond tree significant in biblical imagery.

Nuts can be nourishing foods, but they also require safety awareness.

Nut allergies can be severe.
Some people cannot tolerate nuts.
Portions matter.
Quality and storage matter because nuts can become rancid.

A Christian herbal student must never assume that because a food is biblical, it is safe for everyone.

Safe language:

"Almonds and other nuts are biblical foods that may be nourishing for those who tolerate them. They must be avoided by individuals with nut allergies and used with wisdom."

Flax

Flax is connected with linen in the Bible and has also been studied as a food seed.

Flax can teach students that some plants have multiple uses. A plant may provide fiber for cloth, seed for food, oil, or other practical uses.

Flax may be studied as:

A seed
A fiber plant
A food
A traditional wellness plant
A reminder of daily life in biblical culture

Students must be careful with flax because it is fibrous and may affect digestion. It may also be inappropriate for certain medical situations or medications in larger amounts.

Safe language:

"Flax is a plant with biblical and practical significance. It may be studied as both a fiber plant and food seed, but individual tolerance, medication use, and digestive sensitivity should be considered."

Biblical Spices, Seasonings, and Resins

The Bible mentions many spices, seasonings, and aromatic substances.

Examples include:

Cinnamon
Coriander
Frankincense
Mint
Dill
Balm
Aloes
Myrrh
Rue
Saffron
Spikenard
Calamus

These substances were used in different ways. Some were foods. Some were seasonings. Some were fragrances. Some were expensive trade items. Some were used in burial customs. Some were connected to worship or anointing. Some were symbolic.

The Christian herbal student must study each one carefully.

Do not assume all biblical spices are safe internally.
Do not assume essential oils are the same as the plant in Scripture.
Do not assume a resin used historically should be taken today.
Do not assume “biblical” means “safe for everyone.”
Do not turn fragrance passages into medical prescriptions.

Biblical spices remind us that God’s creation includes aroma, beauty, value, and function. They should be studied with care.

Cinnamon

Cinnamon is mentioned among precious spices. It is fragrant, warming, and historically valued.

Cinnamon may be used in food, teas, and spice blends, but concentrated cinnamon products require caution.

Cassia cinnamon contains coumarin, which can be a concern in high amounts.
Cinnamon may affect blood sugar.
Cinnamon essential oil can irritate skin and should not be used casually.
Cinnamon may not be appropriate in large amounts for everyone.

Safe language:

“Cinnamon is a biblical spice valued for fragrance and flavor. It may be used in food amounts by many people, but concentrated forms require safety awareness.”

Frankincense

Frankincense is one of the gifts presented to Jesus. It was valuable, aromatic, and connected with worship and sacred settings.

Frankincense should be studied with reverence and caution.

Students must not casually recommend internal use of frankincense essential oil. Essential oils are highly concentrated and can be unsafe when misused.

Safe language:

“Frankincense was a valuable biblical resin associated with fragrance, worship, and gifts. In herbal education, it should be studied historically and safely. Essential oil use requires proper training and caution.”

Myrrh

Myrrh is mentioned in Scripture in connection with gifts, fragrance, anointing, and burial.

Myrrh carries deep biblical meaning. It is connected to suffering, sacrifice, value, and preparation.

Like frankincense, myrrh should be studied carefully. It is resinous and strong, and it is not appropriate for everyone.

Safe language:

“Myrrh is a significant biblical resin. It may be studied for its historical, symbolic, and traditional uses, but it should not be used carelessly or presented as a cure.”

Mint, Dill, and Rue

Mint, dill, and rue are mentioned in the New Testament in the context of tithing and religious practice.

Jesus corrected religious leaders who were careful about small matters but neglected judgment, mercy, faith, and the love of God.

This gives Christian herbal students an important lesson.

It is possible to know herbs and miss mercy.
It is possible to be precise and miss love.
It is possible to study plants and neglect the heart.
It is possible to focus on small details while forgetting justice, faith, and compassion.

Mint, dill, and rue remind us that herbal knowledge must never replace righteousness, mercy, and love.

Aloes and Balm

Aloes and balm are also mentioned in Scripture. These plants and aromatic substances had historical and cultural significance.

Students must be careful because the word “aloe” in Scripture may not always refer to the same plant people call aloe vera today. Also, aloe latex can be harsh and is not appropriate for everyone.

Safety reminder:

Aloe products can vary.
Aloe latex is a strong laxative and may be unsafe.
Some people are sensitive or allergic.
Topical use may not be appropriate for everyone.
Pregnant individuals and those with medical conditions should use caution.

Balm is also significant in biblical language, especially the “balm in Gilead” imagery. It reminds us of healing hope, but should not be turned into unsupported claims.

Safe language:

“Aloes and balm have biblical significance and should be studied in context. Students should be careful with plant identification, modern product differences, and safety concerns.”

Food, Herbs, and the Temple of the Body

1 Corinthians 6:19–20 teaches that the body is the temple of the Holy Ghost. This does not mean we worship the body. It means we steward the body.

Food choices can be part of stewardship.

A Christian herbal student should not use food as a weapon.
A Christian herbal student should not shame people for what they eat.

A Christian herbal student should not create fear around every food.
A Christian herbal student should not assume one diet fits everyone.

Instead, teach with wisdom:

Choose simple foods when possible.
Eat with gratitude.
Learn what supports your body.
Avoid foods that cause allergy or harm.
Seek help for medical dietary needs.
Use herbs and spices wisely.
Remember that food is provision, not salvation.

The goal is stewardship, not legalism.

Allergies and Individual Needs

A food or herb can be biblical and still be unsafe for a specific person.

This is very important.

A person may be allergic to fish.
A person may be allergic to nuts.
A person may react to dairy.
A person may be sensitive to garlic.
A person may not tolerate grains.
A person may be pregnant or nursing.
A person may be taking medication.
A person may have blood sugar concerns.
A person may have kidney, liver, heart, or autoimmune conditions.
A person may be a child, elder, or medically fragile.

Biblical does not automatically mean safe for everyone.

A responsible Christian herbalist must always consider the individual.

Safe questions include:

Do you have allergies?
Are you pregnant or nursing?
Are you taking medication?
Do you have a medical diagnosis?
Are you under a provider’s care?
Have you reacted to this food or herb before?

Is this for a child or elder?
Could this require medical guidance?

This is part of loving your neighbor.

Preparation Matters

How a food or herb is prepared matters.

Garlic in food is different from concentrated garlic capsules.
Cinnamon in oatmeal is different from cinnamon essential oil.
Olive oil in food is different from an infused topical oil.
Honey in tea is different from using honey on a wound.
Flax sprinkled on food is different from large amounts taken therapeutically.
A dried herb tea is different from a tincture, capsule, or essential oil.

Preparation changes strength, safety, and use.

A Christian herbal student must learn:

Plant part used
Amount used
Preparation method
Internal vs. external use
Age appropriateness
Contraindications
Medication interactions
Storage
Shelf life
Labeling
Cleanliness

This is why herbal study must be slow and careful.

Safe Educational Language for Biblical Foods and Herbs

When teaching biblical foods and herbs, use careful language.

Instead of saying:

“This biblical food cures disease.”

Say:

“This food is mentioned in Scripture and may be studied as part of biblical nourishment and general wellness education.”

Instead of saying:

“Everyone should take this herb.”

Say:

“This herb may be useful for some people, but safety, allergies, medications, and individual needs must be considered.”

Instead of saying:

“God put this in the Bible, so it must be safe.”

Say:

“Biblical mention does not remove the need for wisdom, context, and safety.”

Instead of saying:

“This oil is anointed, so it will heal you.”

Say:

“We recognize God as the healer and study biblical oils with reverence, not superstition.”

Instead of saying:

“This spice prevents disease.”

Say:

“This spice has traditional food and wellness uses, but we avoid making disease claims.”

Safe language protects truth, students, ministries, and the people we serve.

Simple Biblical Food & Herb Study Method

When studying a biblical food or herb, use this simple method:

1. Identify the Plant or Food

What is the common name?
What is the possible biblical name?
Is there a modern botanical identity?

2. Locate the Scripture

Where is it mentioned?
What book, chapter, and verse?

3. Study the Context

What is happening in the passage?
Is the plant being used as food, fragrance, medicine, gift, worship item, symbol, or household resource?

4. Note Traditional Uses

How has this plant or food been used traditionally?
Was it eaten, infused, pressed, burned, applied, traded, or carried?

5. Consider Modern Use Carefully

How is it used today?
Is it commonly used as food, tea, oil, spice, resin, capsule, or essential oil?

6. Add Safety Notes

Who should avoid it?
Are there allergy risks?
Are there medication concerns?
Is it safe for pregnancy, children, elders, or chronic illness?
Is the preparation concentrated?

7. Write a Spiritual Reflection

What does this plant teach about God’s provision, stewardship, patience, nourishment, or wisdom?

8. Use Educational Language

Avoid diagnosis, cure claims, and prescriptions.

Example Biblical Herb Study: Olive Oil

Name: Olive Oil

Biblical References: Deuteronomy 8:8; Luke 10:34; James 5:14

Biblical Context: Olive oil appears as food, lamp oil, anointing oil, and practical care.

Traditional Use: Used in cooking, skin care, lamps, anointing, and as a carrier oil.

Modern Educational Use: Olive oil may be studied as a nourishing food oil and as a common carrier oil for topical herbal preparations.

Safety Notes: Use caution with rancid oils, allergies, skin sensitivity, and topical use on broken or infected skin. Serious wounds require medical care.

Spiritual Reflection: Olive oil reminds us of provision, light, preparation, and consecration. It points us back to God as Provider and Healer.

Safe Educational Summary: Olive oil is a significant biblical oil used in food, lamps, anointing, and practical care. It may be studied as part of biblical plant education and general wellness stewardship, but it should not be treated as magical or as a replacement for medical care.

Example Biblical Food Study: Honey

Name: Honey

Biblical References: Deuteronomy 8:8; Psalm 119:103

Biblical Context: Honey is connected with abundance, sweetness, food, and the sweetness of God's Word.

Traditional Use: Used as a sweet food and valued gift.

Modern Educational Use: Honey may be used as a natural sweetener by many people.

Safety Notes: Do not give honey to infants under one year old. Use caution with blood sugar concerns and allergies.

Spiritual Reflection: Honey reminds us that God's Word is sweet, nourishing, and desirable.

Safe Educational Summary: Honey is a biblical food associated with sweetness and provision. It may be used as part of food stewardship when appropriate, but it is not a cure and is not safe for infants under one year old.

Teacher's Teaching Notes

When teaching this lesson, help students slow down.

Students may become excited when they see many biblical foods, herbs, oils, and spices. Excitement is good, but it must be guided by wisdom.

Teach students that biblical plant study requires:

Scripture
Context
History
Tradition
Safety
Humility
Educational language
Discernment

Remind students that “biblical” does not automatically mean “safe for everyone.” A person can be allergic to a biblical food. A person can misuse a biblical oil. A person can take a biblical herb in an unsafe preparation. A person can make claims the Bible does not make.

The goal of this lesson is not to memorize a long list of plants.

The goal is to learn how to study them responsibly.

Student Reflection

Answer the following questions in your notebook or student workbook.

1. What biblical food, herb, oil, or spice stood out to you most in this lesson?
2. Why is it important to study biblical plants in context?
3. What is the difference between biblical mention and modern wellness use?
4. Why should students avoid making medical claims about biblical foods and herbs?
5. How can food be part of body stewardship?
6. Why does “biblical” not automatically mean “safe for everyone”?
7. What safety questions should a Christian herbalist ask before teaching about a food or herb?
8. How can olive oil teach both practical and spiritual lessons?
9. How can honey remind us of both nourishment and God’s Word?
10. How can you honor God while studying biblical foods and herbs?

Biblical Food & Herb Study Practice

Choose **three** biblical foods, herbs, oils, or spices from this lesson and complete the short study below for each one.

Name of Food, Herb, Oil, or Spice:

Bible Reference:

How It Appears in Scripture:

Traditional or Historical Use:

Modern Educational Use:

Safety Notes:

Spiritual Reflection:

Safe Educational Summary:

Vocabulary Words

Biblical Food: A food mentioned in Scripture or commonly eaten in biblical culture.

Biblical Herb: An herb or plant connected to Scripture, biblical culture, or traditional biblical lands.

Oil: A pressed plant fat, such as olive oil, used for food, lamps, skin care, anointing, or practical care.

Spice: An aromatic plant substance used for flavor, fragrance, trade, gifts, incense, or traditional use.

Resin: A sticky aromatic substance from certain trees or plants, such as frankincense or myrrh.

Context: The setting, meaning, and purpose of a scripture passage.

Traditional Use: How a plant, food, or preparation has been used historically or culturally.

Safety Note: Information about allergies, contraindications, medication interactions, preparation concerns, or groups who should avoid a plant or food.

Educational Language: Careful wording that teaches without diagnosing, prescribing, treating, curing, or making claims beyond scope.

Lesson 6 Summary

Biblical foods, herbs, oils, and spices reveal God’s provision throughout Scripture. Fruits, grains, legumes, nuts, honey, olive oil, garlic, fish, milk products, flax, spices, and resins all played roles in biblical life.

Christian herbal students must study these plants and foods with reverence and wisdom. A biblical mention does not automatically create a modern medical claim. Students must consider context, traditional use, preparation, safety, allergies, individual needs, and educational boundaries.

Food is part of body stewardship. Herbs and spices may support general wellness education. Oils and resins may teach practical and spiritual lessons. But none of these replace God, medical care, prayer, wisdom, or safety.

Remember:

God is the Provider.
Plants are part of His creation.
Food can nourish the body.
Scripture must be studied in context.
Safety matters.
Allergies matter.
Preparation matters.
Words matter.
Biblical does not mean safe for everyone.
Christ remains the center.

Closing Prayer

Father God,

Thank You for the foods, herbs, oils, spices, fruits, seeds, and trees You have placed upon the earth. Thank You for daily bread, simple nourishment, and the beauty of Your creation.

Teach me to study biblical plants with wisdom and humility. Keep me from exaggeration, unsafe claims, and careless words. Help me understand scripture in context and use knowledge responsibly.

Show me how to steward my body with gratitude. Teach me to honor individual needs, allergies, safety, and proper care. Let every lesson in creation point me back to You as Creator, Provider, and Healer.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Instructor Closing

Students, biblical foods and herbs are beautiful to study, but they must be studied with care.

Do not rush from scripture to claims.
Do not turn every plant into a cure.

Do not ignore allergies or safety.
Do not use biblical language to pressure people.
Do not forget the whole person.

Study the plant.
Study the passage.
Study the context.
Study the preparation.
Study the safety.
Study with humility.

God gave provision, but He also calls us to wisdom.

As Christian herbal students, we honor God by learning carefully, teaching responsibly, and keeping Christ at the center of all we do.